

2026 World Championship

Event Specific Ruleset

v1.0

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1. Background and Purpose

1.1. Purpose.

League of Legends Championship Series LLC, a Delaware limited liability company ("**LE Entity**"), along with its affiliates (collectively, "**Riot**") has created this **2026 World Championship Event-Specific Ruleset** (the "**Event-Specific Ruleset**") to set forth certain policies, rules, and procedures that will apply to all Teams participating in the Mid Season Invitational event. This Event-Specific Ruleset is in addition to, and not in lieu of, the **League of Legends Esports International Events 2026 Competition Ruleset** (the "**Competition Ruleset**") and the **League of Legends Esports: Global Policies** (the "**Global Policies**").

2. Event Eligibility

2.1. Team Member Eligibility

To be eligible to participate in the World Championship ("WCE"), all players, coaches, and managers ("**Team Members**") must satisfy the following conditions:

2.1.1. **Age**. Each Team Member must have been born on or before Oct 15th, 2009 (i.e. at least 17 years old by the first day of the event).

2.1.2. **Residency and Work Eligibility.** Each Team Member must meet the work eligibility requirements for the region they are representing at the WCE.

2.1.3. **No Riot Employees.** Team Members may not be employees of Riot Games Inc. ("**RGI**") or League of Legends Esports Federation LLC or any of their respective affiliates at the start of or at any point during the WCE. "**Affiliate**" is defined as any person or other entity which owns or controls, is under the ownership or control of, or is under common ownership or control with, an Owner. "**Control**" shall mean the power, through any means, to determine the policies or management of an entity, whether through the power to elect, appoint or approve, directly or indirectly, the directors, officers, managers or trustees of such entity or otherwise.

2.1.4. **Team Member Handles.** A Team Member must use the tournament handle the Team Member last used in regional play whilst qualifying for WCE. Name changes are not allowed except under certain extenuating circumstances, and must be approved by WCE officials prior to use in a WCE game.

2.2. Team Eligibility

2.2.1. **Team Qualification**. Teams will qualify for the WCE through regular and postseason play from the region in which they normally compete, and by the rules set forth by that region. Regions have been awarded the following number of berths:

2.2.1.1. China (LPL), South Korea (LCK): 4 Berths

2.2.1.2. EMEA (LEC), North America (LCS), Asia Pacific (LCP): 3 Berths

2.2.1.3. Brazil (CBLOL): 2 Berths

Throughout this ruleset, teams may be referred to by their region and a number, i.e. LCK2 or LCS1. This number refers to the ranking which they achieved through regional play.

2.2.2. **Qualification Revocation**. Teams may have their qualification revoked in any of the following situations:

2.2.2.1. The qualified team is not able to travel to the event location due to local / global travel restrictions, or fail to obtain necessary documents for entering and remaining in any event location country for the duration of the competition (such as visas, travel clearance, etc.) before traveling to WCE.

2.2.2.2. The qualified team is unable to fulfill the roster requirements by the deadline specified by WCE Officials.

2.2.2.3. Other situations that WCE Officials deemed to be necessary to prohibit a qualified team from participating in WCE.

2.2.3. **Team Names, Tags, and Logos.** Each team must use the Team Name, Team Tag, and Team Logo the team last used in regional play whilst qualifying for WCE. Changes are not allowed except under certain extenuating circumstances, and must be approved by WCE officials prior to use.

3. Rosters

3.1. Minimum Roster Requirements

3.1.1. **Players**. Each team must maintain, at all times during the WCE, a roster of at least five Players. A minimum of three of these players must be considered Residents of the region they are representing. Teams may additionally maintain one or two more Players (for a total of six or seven) on their roster.

3.1.2. **Coaches**. Each team must maintain, at all times during the WCE, one Head Coach. Teams may additionally maintain up to three Strategic Coaches on their roster.

3.1.3. **Manager**. Each team must maintain, at all times during the WCE, one Team Manager.

3.2. Roster Deadlines

3.2.1. **Active Roster Lock.** Teams must finalize and submit their Active Roster to WCE officials no later than September 15th, 2026 at 17:59 PST. The Active Roster submitted at this time will be considered the eligible Active Roster for the WCE. This roster may only be composed of players and coaches that are on a team's regional roster. Any changes to a team's Active Roster after the Roster Lock date will be governed by the Roster Emergency Policy in the LoL Esports Global Policies.

3.2.2. **Starting Rosters**. For each game at the WCE, teams must designate five players from their Active Roster as that game's Starting Roster. They must also assign each player on their starting roster to one of the in-game roles (i.e. Top, Jungle, Mid, Bot, Support). No more than one player may select each role. Roster submissions for a Team's first game on any day must be submitted alongside the Team's side and/or pick order selections. Timing for these selections is covered in depth in Section 4.1 of this ruleset. Roster submissions for subsequent games must be submitted no later than 5 minutes after the conclusion of the previous game.

3.3. Attendance

All Team Members must be present for and participate in all required activities, including, but not limited to:

3.3.1. Scheduled Matches

3.3.2. Rehearsal / Tech-Check Periods

3.3.3. Press and/or Media Events

3.3.4. Premium Experiences Program

3.3.5. Any other activities deemed required by WCE Officials

4. Tournament Structure, Schedule, and Prizing

4.1.1. Play-In Stage.

4.1.1.1. Description. Four teams will be seeded into a best-of-five, double elimination bracket. The top team coming out of this bracket will advance to the Swiss Stage. A visual representation of the Play-In Stage is available in the Appendix A as Figure 1.

4.1.1.1.1. The bracket will consist of six best-of-five matches - two Round 1 matches, two Round 2 matches, one Round 3 match, and one Round 4 match.

4.1.1.1.2. The winners of the Round 1 matches will advance to Round 2, Match 1, while the losers will advance to the Round 2, Match 2.

4.1.1.1.3. The winner of Round 2, Match 1 will advance to Round 4. The loser of the Round 2, Match 2 will be eliminated from the WCE as the 19th place finisher.

4.1.1.1.4. The loser of the Round 2 - Match 1 will face the winner of Round 2 - Match 2 in Round 3. The loser of this match will be eliminated from the WCE as the 18th place finisher, while the winner will move on to Round 4.

4.1.1.1.5. The winner of Round 2, Match 1 will face the winner of Round 3 in Round 4. The loser of this match will be eliminated from the WCE as the 17th place finisher, while the winner will advance to the Bracket Stage.

4.1.2. Swiss Stage.

4.1.2.1. Description. Sixteen teams will face off in five rounds of best-of-one and best-of-three matches. The first round will see the teams drawn into eight, best-of-one matches. Following these matches, teams will be paired into eight more best-of-one matches, with each team playing an opponent with the same record. This process will continue until all teams have earned either three match wins or three match losses. Initial matches will be best-of-one, and any match that determines advancement or elimination will be best-of-three. Teams will advance to the Knockout Stage upon earning three match wins, and teams will be

eliminated from the WCE upon earning three match losses. A visual representation of the Swiss Stage is available in Appendix A as Figure 2.

4.1.2.1.1. Round One will consist of eight best-of-one matches.

4.1.2.1.2. Round Two will consist of eight best-of-one matches.

4.1.2.1.3. Round Three will consist of four best-of-three matches and four best-of-one matches. The matches between undefeated teams (i.e. teams with a 2-0 match record) and winless teams (i.e. teams with an 0-2 match record) will be best-of-three, and the remaining matches (i.e. matches between teams with a 1-1 match record) will be best-of-one. Teams that are eliminated during Round Three will be considered the 15th/16th place finishers of the WCE.

4.1.2.1.4. Round Four will consist of six best-of-three matches. Teams that are eliminated during Round Four will be considered the 12th/13th/14th place finishers of the WCE.

4.1.2.1.5. Round Five will consist of three best-of-three matches. Teams that are eliminated during Round Five will be considered the 9th/10th/11th place finishers of the WCE.

4.1.3. Knockout Stage.

4.1.3.1. **Description**. The eight remaining teams will be drawn into an eight team, best-of-five, single elimination bracket with three rounds: Quarterfinals, Semifinals, and Finals. A visual representation of the Knockout Stage is available in the Appendix A as Figure 3.

4.1.3.1.1. Teams that win their matches in the quarterfinals will advance to the semifinals. Teams that lose their matches will be eliminated from the WCE as 5th-8th place finishers.

4.1.3.1.2. Teams that win their matches in the semifinals will advance to the finals. Teams that lose their matches will be eliminated from the WCE as 3rd/4th place finishers.

4.1.3.1.3. The team that wins the finals will be the 2025 WCE Champion. The team that loses the finals will be eliminated from the WCE as the 2nd place finisher.

4.1.4. First Selection.

4.1.4.1. For every match at WCE other than the Round 4 of the Play-In, one team will earn the Right of First Selection (“RoFS”) for Game 1. The team with RoFS may select between two pre-game choices: their preferred pick position or their preferred map side. Their opponent will be granted their preference on the choice that the initial team did not select.

4.1.4.1.1. As an example, if the team with RoFS selected “First Pick,” the opponent would be able to select “Blue Side” or “Red Side.”

4.1.4.2. Play-In Stage Round Specifics:

4.1.4.2.1. For Rounds 1, 2 and 3, RoFS for Game 1 of each series will be determined by coinflip or other equivalent method (i.e. Draw Order, when applicable).

4.1.4.2.2. For Round 4, the team coming from Round 2, Match 1 will have the Right of Dual Selection (“RoDS”) for Game 1. They will be granted both their preferred pick position as well as their preferred map side.

4.1.4.3. Swiss Stage Round Specifics:

4.1.4.3.1. For the Swiss Stage, RoFS for Game 1 will be granted to the team with a higher regional seed. If both teams have the same regional seed, RoFS will be determined by coinflip or other equivalent method (i.e. Draw Order, when applicable).

4.1.4.4. Knockout Stage Round Specifics:

4.1.4.4.1. For the Quarterfinals, RoFS for Game 1 will be granted to the team with the best match record from the Swiss Stage. In the case where both teams have the same match record, RoFS will be determined by the order teams are drawn in the Quarterfinal Draw (see section 4.3 for more information).

4.1.4.4.2. For the Semifinals and Finals, RoFS for Game 1 will be determined by coinflip or other equivalent method.

4.1.4.5. Submission Timing.

4.1.4.5.1. Each Team will make their selections simultaneously and will submit them blindly to WCE Officials. To enable this process, the team with RoFS must submit their selection/choice (i.e., “Red Side”), and the team without RoFS must submit their selections for both choices (i.e. “First Pick, Red Side”). The selection that is not used will be kept confidential and not shared with the opposing team. For pre-determined RoFS (i.e. when decided by regional seed), the Selection Submissions are due at 5:00 PM local time the night before the match, or one hour following the completion of matches if a team is competing on the day the submission is due. For randomly determined RoFS, the Selection Submissions are due no later than 5 minutes following the determination of RoFS.

4.1.4.6. **Subsequent Games.** Within any match, for all games after the first, the losing Team of the previous game will have the RoFS. Both Selection Submissions will be due within 5 minutes of the end of the previous game.

4.2. Tournament Seeding

Teams have been seeded into the tournament to start in one of two stages - The Play-In stage or the Swiss Stage.

4.2.1. Teams starting in the Play-In Stage:

4.2.1.1. 2nd Qualifier from the CBLOL

4.2.1.2. 3rd Qualifier from the LCS

4.2.1.3. 3rd Qualifier from the LEC

4.2.1.4. 3rd Qualifier from the LCP

4.2.2. Teams starting in the Swiss Stage:

4.2.2.1. 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th Qualifiers from the LPL

4.2.2.2. 1st, 2nd, 3rd and 4th Qualifiers from the LCK

4.2.2.3. 1st and 2nd Qualifiers from the LEC

4.2.2.4. 1st and 2nd Qualifiers from the LCS

4.2.2.5. 1st and 2nd Qualifiers from the LCP

4.2.2.6. 1st Qualifier from the CBLOL

4.3. Tournament Draws

4.3.1. Play-In Stage Draw

4.3.1.1. **Draw Procedure**. Teams will be drawn into matches by random selection. There will be no draw pools for the Play-In. The order of the draw will not determine the order in which the matches are played.

4.3.1.2. **Draw Restrictions**. There are no specific restrictions for the Play-In draw.

4.3.2. Swiss Draw - Round One

4.3.2.1. **Draw Pools**. Teams have been split into four draw pools for the purposes of the Swiss Stage.

4.3.2.1.1. Pool 1: LCK1, LPL1, LCS1, LEC1

4.3.2.1.2. Pool 2: LCP1, CBLOL1, LCK2, LPL2

4.3.2.1.3. Pool 3: LCS2, LEC2, LCK3, LPL3

4.3.2.1.4. Pool 4: LCP2, LPL4, LCK4, Play-In Winner

4.3.2.2. **Draw Procedure**. Teams will be drawn into matches by random selection against an opponent from their matched pool (i.e., Pool 1 vs Pool 4, and Pool 2 vs Pool 3). The order of the draw will not determine the order in which the matches are played.

4.3.2.3. **Draw Restrictions**. There will be no intra-regional matches in Round One of the Swiss Stage. In the case where a draw would result in this scenario, or would force this scenario in a future draw, the drawn team will move to the next available slot.

4.3.3. Swiss Draws - Rounds Two through Five

4.3.3.1. **Draw Procedure**. All teams will be randomly paired with an opponent who has the same match record as them. The order of

the draw will not determine the order in which the matches are played.

4.3.3.2. **Draw Restrictions**. There will be no repeated matches throughout the Swiss Stage (i.e. if two teams met in Round 1, regardless of record, they would not be eligible to play again in Rounds 3, 4, or 5). In the case where a draw would result in this scenario, or would force this scenario in a future draw, the drawn team will move to the next available slot. In the case where there are no eligible draws due to this rule, it may be waived by WCE officials.

4.3.4. Knockout Stage Draw

4.3.4.1. **Draw Procedure**. Teams that finish the Swiss Stage with a (3-0) match record will be randomly paired against teams that finish the Swiss Stage with a (3-2) match record. Following this draw, the remaining four teams will be randomly paired into two matchups.

4.3.4.2. **Bracket Construction**. The two (3-2) vs. (3-0) matches will be placed on opposite sides of the Knockout Bracket. The remaining match placements will be determined by draw order.

4.3.4.3. **Draw Restrictions**. There are no additional restrictions for the Knockout Stage draw.

4.3.5. Tournament Draw Schedule

4.3.5.1. Swiss Round 1 Draw: Immediately following completion of matches on Oct 18.

4.3.5.2. Swiss Round 2 Draw: Immediately following completion of matches on Oct 23.

4.3.5.3. Swiss Round 3 Draw: Immediately following completion of matches on Oct 24.

4.3.5.4. Swiss Round 4 Draw: Immediately following completion of matches on Oct 26.

4.3.5.5. Swiss Round 5 Draw: Immediately following completion of matches on Oct 30.

4.3.5.6. Quarterfinal Draw: Immediately following completion of matches on Oct 31.

4.4. Tournament Play Schedule

4.4.1. Dates of Tournament Stages.

4.4.1.1. Play In Stage: Oct 15-18

4.4.1.2. Swiss Stage: Oct 23 - Oct 26, Oct 28 - Oct 31

4.4.1.3. Bracket Stage - Quarterfinals: Nov 3 - Nov 6

4.4.1.4. Bracket Stage - Semifinals: Nov 7 - Nov 8

4.4.1.5. Bracket Stage - Finals: Nov 14

4.4.2. Changes to Schedule. Match order, dates, and scheduling are at the sole discretion of the WCE. WCE officials may, at their sole discretion, re-order the schedule of matches within a given day and/or change the date of a WCE match to a different date or otherwise modify the schedule of matches. In the event that the WCE modifies a match schedule, the WCE will notify all teams at the earliest convenience.

4.5. Tournament Prizing

Prizing for the WCE will consist of a percentage share of a prize pool provided by the tournament organizer of $5 million USD. Prizes will awarded with the following distribution:

Placement	Percentage	Cash Prize
1st	20.0%	$1,000,000
2nd	16.0%	$800,000
3rd - 4th	8.0% each	$400,000
5th - 8th	6.0% each	$300,000
9th - 11th	3.5% each	$175,000
12th - 14th	2.5% each	$125,000
15th - 16th	1.8% each	$90,000
17th	1.0%	$50,000
18th	0.8%	$40,000
19th	0.6%	$30,000

5. Competitive Patch

5.1. The WCE will be played on the 26.20 patch. Changes to the competitive patch will be at the discretion of the WCE. Any champion, item, rune, skin, or exploit may be disabled at any point at the discretion of WCE officials, including during a match. A list of restricted champions, items, runes, and exploits will be provided to all teams before the event.

6. Spirit of the Rules

6.1. Finality of Decisions

All decisions regarding the interpretation of these Rules, Player eligibility, scheduling and staging of the WCE, and penalties for misconduct, lie solely with the WCE, the decisions of which are final. WCE decisions with respect to these Rules cannot be appealed and shall not give rise to any claim for monetary damages or any other legal or equitable remedy.

6.2. Rule Changes

These Rules may be amended, modified or supplemented by the League, from time to time, in order to ensure fair play and the integrity of the League.

6.3. Language Differences

These Rules may be presented in a variety of languages to the competitors of the event. In any scenario in which the translation of these rules creates a conflict, the English version of this ruleset will prevail.

6.4. Best Interests of the WCE

WCE Officials at all times may act with the necessary authority to preserve the best interests of the WCE. This power is not constrained by the lack of any specific language in this document. WCE Officials may use any form of punitive actions at their disposal against any entity whose conduct is not within the confines of the best interests of the WCE.

Glossary of Terms

Game. An instance of competition on the Summoner's Rift map that is played until a winner is determined by one of the following methods, whichever occurs first: (a) completion of the final objective (destruction of a nexus), (b) Team Surrender, (c) Team Forfeit, or (d) Awarded Game Victory (see Section 8.8).

Match. A set of games that is played until one team wins a majority of the total games (e.g., winning the game in a single game match ("Best of One"); winning two games out of three ("Best of Three"); winning three games out of five ("Best of Five")).

Player. An individual athlete who has a written contract for player services with the team they are playing for, and who is listed as a player for the team on the League of Legends Esports League-Recognized Contract Database.

Head Coach. An individual who has a written contract for coaching services with the team they are playing for, and who is listed as a coach for the team on the League of Legends Esports League-Recognized Contract Database. This individual may not be a player, owner, or manager of any professional, semi-professional, or academy level team.

Strategic Coach. An individual who has a written contract with the team they are representing. This individual may be a substitute player, analyst, translator, or other member of the qualified team. This individual may not act as a head coach without written permission from WCE officials.

Manager. The manager is an individual, designated by the team, who is responsible for administering Team commitments associated with participation in the WCE, including, but not limited to, content requests, Event Schedule notifications, on-site coordination, and information passthrough. This person may not be a player or the Head Coach for any team, including the one they are managing.

Team Personnel. Any credentialed member of team staff, including players, coaches, managers, and other staff.

Active Roster. The five, six or seven Players and Head Coach representing a professional team.

Qualifying Leagues. The leagues that qualify for the World Championship are the Campeonato Brasileiro de League of Legends (CBLOL), League of Legends Pro League (LPL), the League of Legends Champions Korea (LCK), the League of Legends EMEA Championship (LEC), the League of Legends Championship Series (LCS), and the League of Legends Championship Pacific (LCP)

Appendix A - Figures

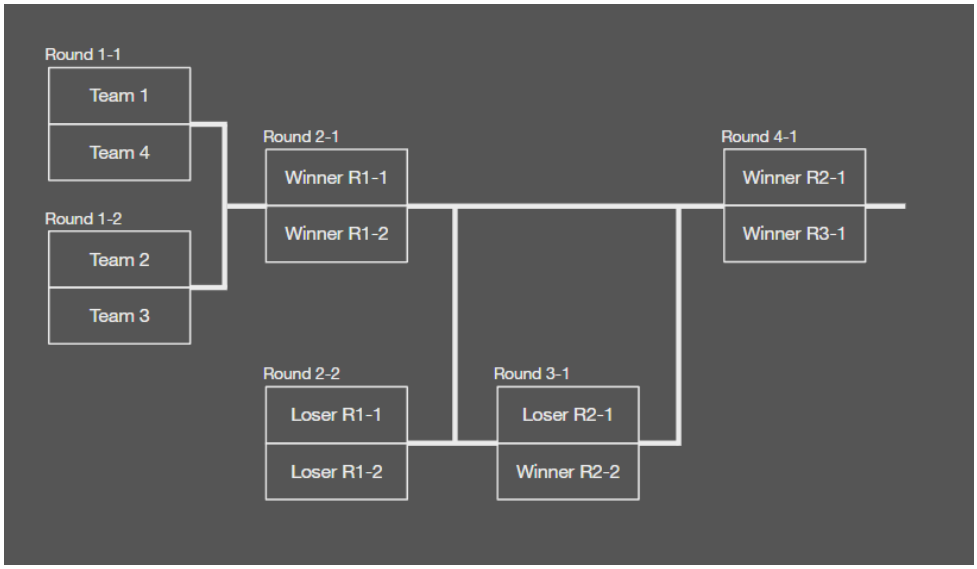


Figure 1- Play-In Stage Bracket

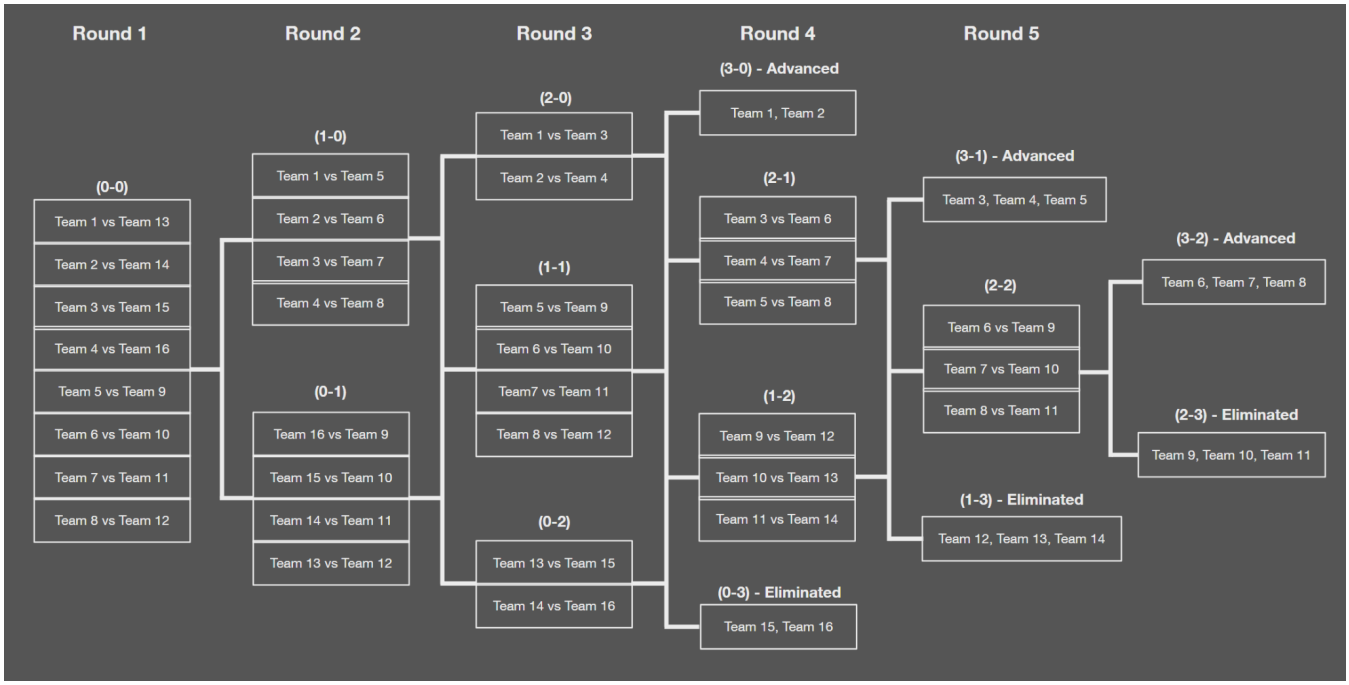


Figure 2 - Swiss Stage Bracket

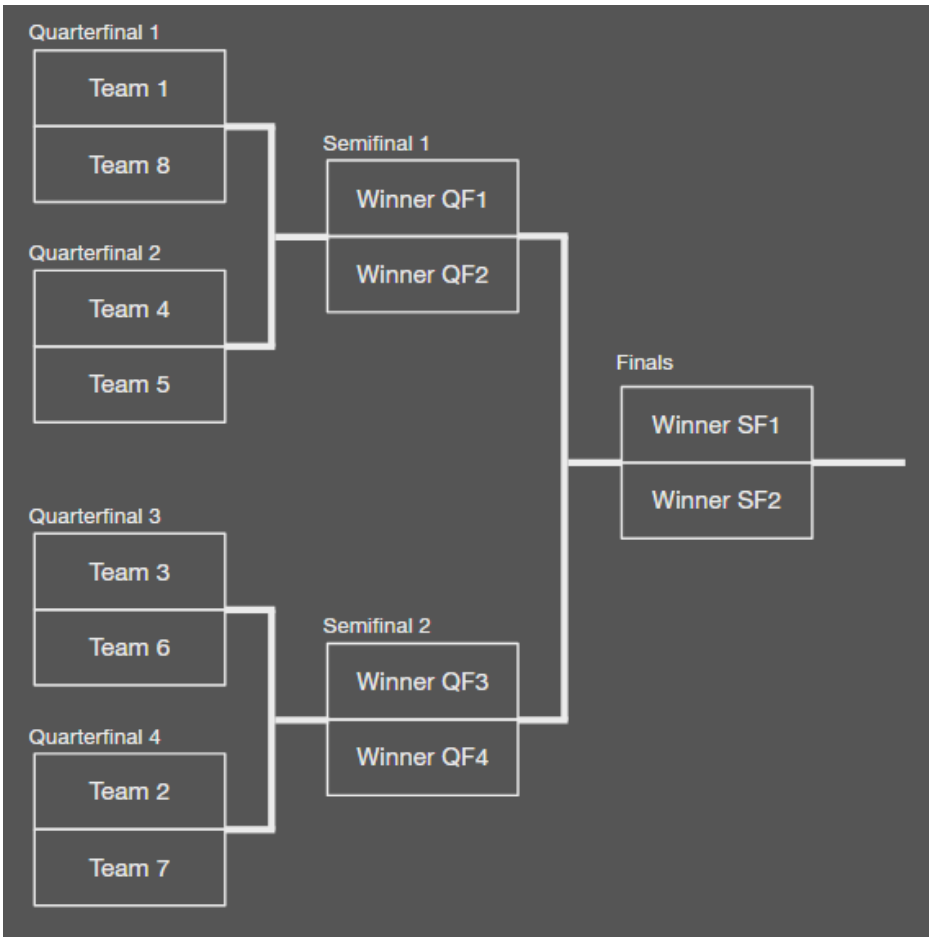


Figure 3 - Knockout Stage Bracket